"I'm going crazy."

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Where it often comes from

Racing thoughts, panic, intrusive images, flashbacks, or strange sensations can be frightening and make us fear losing our minds. Fear of "going crazy" often intensifies the very symptoms, and secrecy deepens it.

What Scripture teaches

God has not given us "a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and self-control" (2 Timothy 1:7). "When anxiety overwhelms me, Your consolation delights my soul." "You will keep in perfect peace the steadfast of mind, because he trusts in You." "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you." Anxiety and distress are among the most common human experiences, and they are treatable. They do not mean you are losing your mind. Tell a doctor or counselor right away if symptoms are severe or frightening.

> *"For God has not given us a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and self-control"* (2 Timothy 1:7).

Also see

> "When anxiety overwhelms me, Your consolation delights my soul" (Psalm 94:19).

> "You will keep in perfect peace the steadfast of mind, because he trusts in You" (Isaiah 26:3).

> "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you" (1 Peter 5:7).

> "Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus" (Philippians 4:6–7).

Common self-statements

- I am losing my mind.
- I am going to snap.
- I cannot control my thoughts.
- Something terrible is happening in my head.
- I am out of control.
- If anyone knew they would lock me up.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either sane or going crazy.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will lose control.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling terrified and concluding that I am going crazy.
- Catastrophizing: Calling myself crazy.

Challenging questions

- What exactly am I experiencing?
- Has a doctor or counselor evaluated these symptoms?

- How often do these fears come true?
- What helps calm my body, like slow breathing or prayer?
- Who can I tell?
- What does Scripture say about God's gift of a sound mind?

Truth summary

> These experiences are frightening but common and treatable. God gives power, love, and self-control, and I can seek help right away. I am not alone.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Anxiety/Worry
- Fear
- Peace
- Therapy
- Depression, Symptoms of

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm going crazy"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm going crazy." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What exactly am I experiencing?
- ☐ Has a doctor or counselor evaluated these symptoms?
- ☐ How often do these fears come true?
- ☐ What helps calm my body, like slow breathing or prayer?
- ☐ Who can I tell?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about God's gift of a sound mind?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God gives me power, love, and self-control.
- ☐ His consolation delights my soul.
- ☐ He keeps me in perfect peace.
- ☐ He cares for me.
- ☐ Help is available.
- ☐ I am not alone.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 2 Timothy 1:7
  "For God has not given us a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and self-control."
- ☐ Psalm 94:19
  "When anxiety overwhelms me, Your consolation delights my soul."
- ☐ Isaiah 26:3
  "You will keep in perfect peace the steadfast of mind, because he trusts in You."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Calm and supported: Each week, note one step you took for calm and one person you told.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, 2 Timothy 1:7 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God has given me power, love, and a sound mind.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Anxiety/Worry" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Talk to a professional. See your doctor or a counselor soon.
- ☐ Slow your breathing. Breathe in for four, out for six.
- ☐ Tell someone safe. Do not hide it.
- ☐ If you feel unsafe, call or text 988 (U.S.). Call 911 in an emergency.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm going crazy": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Calm and supported
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm going crazy.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am afraid for my mind. Calm me, send help, and keep me in Your peace. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.